

GENDER



BENDERS

Aniket Shingote v/s Amruta Sawant
Boot A PC From A (bootable) CD

Raring to go, Aniket sets out like an expert. Rebooting the PC, he presses the 'Delete' key that leads to the BIOS setup utility. But hey, the screen looks different and the advanced BIOS features option is nowhere to be seen! Fortunately, Aniket notices the 'Boot' tab. He alters the order of the boot devices and sits back relaxed. Not bad at all.



Edgy to start with, Amruta lightens up once she hears the task. Calmly, she reboots the PC and waits. Before we can even bat an eyelid, she suddenly presses F8, which directly takes her to the 'Select Boot Device' table. Presto! She carries out the changes effortlessly, all the time chuckling to herself. Piece of cake!

cars, kill people and pick up commercial sex workers!

"Many children who love computer games find it hard to concentrate on the sort of tasks that require slow application and are necessary for school success," said Prof Winston.

To reach his conclusions, Prof Winston studied the impact of computer games on children's ability to tackle various tasks. He found that

those who spend long periods playing quick-fire, adrenaline-pumping games often lack a long-term attention span. Children who have PCs and TVs in their bedroom tend to sit in front of the screen into the early hours instead of getting enough sleep.

"Children are sleeping between two and five hours less than their parents did at the same age. This affects performance at school and



the behaviour at home and some of this is due to games," he added.

"Digital media may well have some dangers as well as some advantages for children. Modern children are spending three to four hours a day in front of a PC or TV screen of some kind, often unsupervised," lamented Winston.

IS THIS THE REAL THING?

A New
'Broadband'
On The Block

BSNL launched the first 'Broadband' service in the country on January 14, 2005. Prior to this, the Department of Telecommunication (DoT) officially recognised 'broadband' as 'Internet with connection speed at a minimum of 256 Kbps'.

With the launch of its 'DataOne' services, BSNL has become the first Internet Service Provider (ISP) to promise bandwidth

up to 2 Mbps in two packages, namely, the 'Home Plan' for single terminals and the 'Business Plan' that allows multiple terminals to access the Net on a single connection.

Based on Asymmetric Digital Subscriber Line (ADSL) technology, DataOne allows copper telephone pairs to be used to provide a broadband connection.

DataOne starts at Rs 500 per month and goes up to Rs 9,000 per month (Business Plan). Other players in the market, such as Airtel Broadband and Reliance Broadband, are still offering speeds of 64 Kbps, and they are calling that 'broadband'!

While Airtel offers the 64 Kbps package at Rs 249 per month, DataOne offers 256 Kbps at Rs 500. Reliance also offers bandwidth speeds between 64 Kbps and 100 Kbps, but nothing compared to the 1 Mbps being offered by BSNL.

As the largest telecom service provider in India, BSNL has an edge over private players.

N Chenjaya, general manager, BSNL, says, "We think broadband will be a success because our network is our strength. We have a good reach across the country and can reach out to the masses faster."

The private players would agree. With plans to use the power of the Internet for e-governance and to put into place a centralised State Wide Area Network (SWAN) across various states in India, BSNL will now be in both voice and data spaces

DART—Deep-ocean Assessment and Reporting of Tsunamis

Designed to detect Tsunamis as small as one centimetre, DART systems consist of a seafloor Bottom Pressure Recording (BPR) system and a moored surface buoy. The BPR runs an algorithm that generates predicted water height values and compares new samples with the predicted values.

An acoustic modem transmits data—on an hourly basis—from the BPR to the buoy, which is then relayed through a Geostationary Operational Environmental Satellites (GOES) satellite link to ground stations. Ground stations demodulate the signals and broadcast the readings to Tsunami Warning Centres worldwide.

Buzzword
of the MONTH